

Igor Kolesnikov

CV

✉ igor_kolesnikov@berkeley.edu

Education

UC Berkeley, Department of Political science

PhD in Political Science

Berkeley, US

2022 - 2028

National Research University Higher School of Economics,

BA in Political Science, Political Analysis subfield

Moscow, Russia

2018 - 2022

National Research University Higher School of Economics

Minor, Intelligent Data Analysis

2019 - 2021

Publications and Research

Maxim Slav, Elena Smyslovskikh, Vladimir Novikov, Igor Kolesnikov, Andrey Korotayev *"Deprivation, instability, and propensity to attack: how urbanization influences terrorism"* International Interactions (2021)

Eva Davoine, Joseph Enguehard, Victor Gay, Igor Kolesnikov, *Mapping the Grandes Gabelles in Early Modern France*, Explorations in Economic History (2026)

Ongoing projects

"Surviving the commons: Communal Land Tenure, Extraction and Political Control".

Presented at the CPD workshop 2025 at UC Berkeley, Summer Workshop in the Economic History and Historical Political Economy of Eurasia 2026

"Landowners into Bureaucrats: Decentralization and Local Administration in the Russian Empire" with Otto Kienitz. Presented at Stanford HSS Workshop 2025, Summer Workshop in the Economic History and Historical Political Economy of Eurasia 2023, 2026, the 2024 Berkeley-Stanford Bay Area Economic History Workshop, The 2025 Andrea Mitchell Center for the Study of Democracy Graduate workshop series

"The Political Costs of Taxation," with Eva Davoine and Joseph Enguehard. Presented at EHA 2022 (single-authored poster), SDU HEDG Workshop 2024, EHS 2024, FRESH Louvain 2024, ASREC Europe 2024, LSE EH graduate seminar. Available at <https://www.taxobservatory.eu/publication/the-political-costs-of-taxation/>

Awards:

- Selected for the NBER SI Political Economy (2025)
- Best Ph.D. Student Paper Award, International Tax and Public Finance (2025)
- Finalist, CESifo Award in Public Economics (2025)

"Elite Selection: Party Composition and Purges in the Soviet Union". with Liza Brover

Guns, Garrisons, and Growth: Revisiting State Formation in Africa with Leonardo Arriola, Igor Kolesnikov, Martha Wilfahrt Yosef Tadesse. Presented at MPSA 2024, APSA 2024, APSA 2025

Legacies of Incorporation: Land Tenure and State Capacity in Ethiopia with Leonardo Arriola, Igor Kolesnikov, Martha Wilfahrt Yosef Tadesse. Presented at APSA 2026

"Spreading Insurgency: Evidence from the Russian October Revolution," with Vladimir Novikov. Presented at Summer Workshop in the Economic History and Historical Political Economy of Eurasia 2023, VWHPE 2024, and MPSA 2024

Research Assistance

Logic(s) of Historical Persistence (author: Jason Wittenberg).

Repressions of the USSR High Military Command (author: Alexey Zakharov).

Regional Variation in Restrictions and Transfers in Russia during the Covid-19 pandemic (author: Ekaterina Borisova)

Electoral turnout decisions in the aftermath of 2018 Armenian Revolution (authors: Cemal Eren Arbatli and David Gomtsyan)

Teaching Experience

Graduate Student Instructor with Sean Gailmard <i>Formal Models of Political Science</i>	UC Berkeley <i>Spring 2026</i>
Graduate Student Instructor with Stephanie Zonszein <i>Advanced Topics in Causal Inference</i>	UC Berkeley <i>Spring 2025</i>
Graduate Student Instructor with Sean Gailmard <i>Game Theory in the Social Sciences</i>	UC Berkeley <i>Summer 2025</i>
Graduate Student Instructor with Jason Wittenberg <i>Introduction to Empirical Analysis and Quantitative Methods</i>	UC Berkeley <i>Fall 2024</i>

Work Experience

Center for Advanced Governance, https://cpur.ru/en/ <i>Junior Data Analyst</i>	Moscow, Russia <i>2021 - 2022</i>
International Center for the Study of Institutions and Development, HSE <i>Research Assistant</i>	<i>2020 - 2021</i>
Department of Theoretical Economics, Higher School of Economics <i>Research Assistant</i>	<i>2020 - 2021</i>
National Research University Higher School of Economics Lyceum <i>Tutor of an elective course for preparation for Social Science Olympiads for school students</i>	<i>2019 - 2021</i>
The National Academic Competition for Schoolchildren preparatory courses <i>Teacher, Department of Social Sciences</i>	<i>2018 - 2020</i>

Higher School of Economics

Course Assistant in History of Political thought, Political Theory, Political Sociology

2019 - Present

Skills

Programming Language	Python, R, JAGS, SQL
Research Tool	Rstudio, Google Colab, QGIS, Crowd-sourcing platforms (Toloka, Amazon Mechanical Turk)
DBMS	Dbeaver
Empirical Methods	Panel Data Analysis, Time Series, Bayesian statistics, Regression Discontinuity, Difference-in-Difference, IV, Decision trees, NLP
Languages	Russian (native), English (fluent), French (beginner)

Professional Service

- Presenter, 47th Annual Berkeley-Stanford Conference on Slavic, East European, and Eurasian Studies.
- Presenter, Conference of the Society for Institutional Organizational Economics (Summer 2022).
- Presenter, "Exhibition of Scientific Achievements" (VDNKh) (Summer 2022).
- Presenter, MPSA (Spring 2023, Spring 2025)
- Presenter, Bay Area Student Economic History Workshop (Spring 2023)
- Graduate Student Organizer, Formal Theory Group
- Presenter, APSA (Fall 2024)
- Presenter, Stanford Historical Social Science Workshop
- Organizer, Development and Political Economics Conference (Spring 2026)

Fellowships and Grants

- Designated Emphasis 2023 in Political Economy Scholars Small Research Grant
- ISEES Summer 2023 Research Fellowship
- ISEES Summer 2024 Research Fellowship
- ISEES 2025 Academic Year Dissertation Fellowship
- BESI 2023-2024 Political Economy Research Award
- BESI 2024-2025 Political Economy Research Award
- BESI Political Economy Conference Travel Grant FY 2024
- Simpson Pre-Dissertation Fellowship 2024
- James Goldgeier Fellowship for International Research 2026
- IHS Humane Studies fellowship 2026
- The Reinhard Bendix and Allan Sharlin Fellowships 2026
- APSA Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grants 2026